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2027 新领军学科能力测试·预测训练卷

二试·语言·英语

（考试时间：建议 2 小时（训练设置）　　满分：100 分）

注意事项

1. 本卷共 3 部分 13 题，满分 100 分，建议用时 2 小时。2027 年简章列出二试“语言（语文、英语）”，未公布题型、时长与分值；本卷安排均为训练设置。
2. 全部阅读与翻译材料为本卷编写。2027 年的面试含英文面试，本卷侧重学术阅读、准确翻译与论证性写作。

题号	I	II	III	总分
得分				
评卷人				

得分	评卷人

一、Part I　Reading Comprehension（40 分。选择题每题 4 分，简答题每题 4 分）

Passage A

The Quiet Power of the Counterexample

Mathematics is often presented as a tower of theorems, each resting firmly on the ones below. Students learn the statements, practise the proofs, and move on. What this picture leaves out is the scaffolding that was taken down once the tower was finished: the failed attempts, the plausible conjectures that turned out to be false, and above all the counterexamples that showed exactly where an idea broke.

A counterexample is a single case in which a general claim fails. It may seem a purely negative object — it destroys rather than builds — but working mathematicians value it highly. One reason is economy. A conjecture about infinitely many objects can never be confirmed by checking examples, however many we check; a single well-chosen counterexample settles the matter at once. Another reason is precision. When a statement fails, the way it fails usually tells us which hypothesis was missing. A function that is continuous everywhere but differentiable nowhere does not merely refute the belief that continuity implies smoothness; it forces us to say clearly what extra conditions smoothness requires.

There is also a less obvious benefit. Searching for a counterexample is an excellent way to understand a theorem that is true. If you try to break a result and fail, the reasons for your failure are, very often, the ideas of the proof. A student who has tried to construct a bounded increasing sequence that does not converge, and has seen why every attempt collapses, understands the completeness of the real numbers better than one who has only memorised the definition.

None of this means that examples are more important than proofs. A counterexample can only show that something is false; it cannot, on its own, tell us what is true. But it changes the attitude with which we read mathematics. Instead of asking "How do I remember this?", we begin to ask "What would it take to make this fail?" That second question is slower, and sometimes uncomfortable, yet it is the one that turns a list of results into a landscape we can find our way around.

1. （本题满分 4 分）In the first paragraph, "the scaffolding" refers to（　　）

   A. the axioms on which all theorems rest
   B. the failed attempts and false conjectures behind finished results
   C. the textbooks students use to practise proofs
   D. the diagrams used to illustrate theorems

2. （本题满分 4 分）Why does the author mention a function that is continuous everywhere but differentiable nowhere?（　　）

   A. To show that continuity and differentiability are unrelated.
   B. To illustrate how a counterexample reveals a missing hypothesis.
   C. To prove that smooth functions are rare.
   D. To argue that examples matter more than proofs.

3. （本题满分 4 分）The word "settles" in the second paragraph is closest in meaning to（　　）

   A. delays　　B. decides　　C. complicates　　D. records

4. （本题满分 4 分）Which of the following best describes the author's attitude towards counterexamples?（　　）

   A. Dismissive.　　B. Appreciative but balanced.
   C. Uncritically enthusiastic.　　D. Indifferent.

5. （本题满分 4 分）In about 30 words, explain how trying to find a counterexample can help a student understand a theorem that is true.

Passage B

Thinking in Orders of Magnitude

How many piano tuners work in Chicago? The question, which the physicist Enrico Fermi is said to have enjoyed posing to his students, seems unanswerable without a directory. Yet a reasonable estimate can be reached in a few minutes. Suppose the city has about three million people, and roughly one household in twenty owns a piano. With perhaps three people per household, that gives some fifty thousand pianos. If each piano is tuned once a year, and a tuner can service four pianos a day for about two hundred and fifty working days, one tuner handles a thousand pianos a year — so the city needs on the order of fifty tuners.

Every number in this chain is uncertain, some of them by a factor of two or more. Why, then, should the answer be trusted at all? Part of the reason is that errors tend to cancel: an overestimate in one step is often balanced by an underestimate in another. If each factor is off by a random amount, the logarithm of the final answer is a sum of independent errors, and such a sum grows more slowly than the number of terms. The other part of the reason is more important. The value of the estimate lies less in its exact figure than in its order of magnitude. Knowing that the answer is fifty rather than five or five thousand is already a real piece of knowledge.

Scientists use the same habit of mind constantly. Before running an expensive experiment or a long computation, they ask what size of result to expect. If the final number differs wildly from the rough estimate, either the estimate rested on a wrong assumption or something has gone wrong in the detailed work — and both possibilities are worth knowing about. In this sense an estimate is not a substitute for careful measurement but a check on it, a way of keeping our more elaborate reasoning honest.

6. （本题满分 4 分）What is the main purpose of the first paragraph?（　　）

A. To describe the piano industry in Chicago.

B. To show how a seemingly impossible question can be estimated step by step.

C. To criticise the way Fermi taught his students.

D. To list reliable statistics about households.

7. （本题满分 4 分）Using the passage's figures, if a tuner could service only two pianos a day (everything else unchanged), the estimate would become about（　　）

A. 25　　B. 50　　C. 100　　D. 200

8. （本题满分 4 分）According to the passage, why can the estimate be trusted although its inputs are uncertain?（　　）

A. Every input is checked against a directory.

B. Errors in different steps partly cancel, and only the order of magnitude matters.

C. Fermi's figures were exact.

D. Pianos are tuned at regular intervals.

9. （本题满分 4 分）The phrase "keeping our more elaborate reasoning honest" most nearly means（　　）

A. preventing scientists from lying

B. detecting errors in detailed work by comparing it with a rough expectation

C. making long computations faster

D. replacing measurement with guesswork

10. （本题满分 4 分）In about 30 words, explain why scientists make a rough estimate before a long

computation or an expensive experiment.

得分	评卷人

二、Part II　Translation（30 分，每题 15 分）

11.（本题满分 15 分）把下面的英文译成中文。

A proof does more than certify that a statement is true. It explains why it is true, and in doing so it often reveals connections that were invisible before. This is why mathematicians sometimes publish new proofs of old theorems: the result is not in doubt, but a different argument may illuminate a different side of it, or suggest how it might be generalised.

12.（本题满分 15 分）把下面的中文译成英文。

学习数学的乐趣，往往不在于记住了多少公式，而在于某一刻突然看清了事物之间的联系。这样的时刻不会凭空出现，它需要长时间的思考、反复的尝试，甚至一次次的失败。但正是这些看似没有结果的努力，让最后的理解变得牢固。

得分	评卷人

三、Part III　Writing（30 分）

13.（本题满分 30 分）Some people believe that the best way to learn mathematics is to solve as many problems as possible. Others argue that it is better to study fewer problems in greater depth. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Support your argument with reasons and, if possible, with an example from your own learning. Write 200–250 words.